

Miner nine wins three

Baseball is back!

UT El Paso opened 'its' season by taking three out of four exhibition games with Ranger Junior College last weekend at Dudley Field.

In the first game, the Miners took advantage of a number of Ranger miscues to take a 8-7 victory. Joe Pennies homered for the Miners with none on in the fifth inning.

Coach Andy Cohen's diamond-men swept the doubleheader behind the four hits shutout pitching of Mike Hilton. Third baseman Glenn Villarreal and centerfield Herb Von Hagen led the Miner hitting attack. Mike Miller drilled one over the wall in the second with none on. Hilton struck out eight enroute to the 4-0 win.

On Saturday, the Miner nine split two with the defending national JC champs. The first game saw Ranger use a 12-hit attack to take a 10-6 victory. The Miners had 11 hits but left 14 men on base. Bob Downing homered for the Miners in the third frame with none on and Rick Jones hit a two-run homes for Ranger in the fourth.

The second game saw the Miners take advantage of the wildness of Ranger starting pitcher, Randy Blansett, and followed with 14 hits to smother Ranger, 13-6. Gene Flores slammed one over the left field wall in the first with two on. The home run call was disputed by Miner players and coaches as the ball appeared to be foul.

Miner third baseman Glenn Villarreal paced the team by going eight for 14 (.571) in the series. His play in the field was sparkling.

The Miners begin a 52-game regular season today and Friday with two twin bills against Hardin-Simmons University at Dudley Field. Starting time is 1 p.m.